

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The struggle is real.



Learning Outcome

Explain customs and appropriate behaviour at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Ask your partner:

- What was the most difficult thing you had to deal with at work?
- How did you deal with it?

Can Do Statements

- I can explain basic rules, policies, or laws that could affect me negatively and answer questions about them.
- I can talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.





Let's Explore!

The team tries to **avert*** the crisis.

* To "avert" means to avoid or prevent.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** My professor had always told me that 'one can never be prepared for a crisis'. He was right.
- Miranda:** We all know this wasn't supposed to happen, Janet. Let's focus. The issue will be dealt with. Where do we start?
- Janet:** I am supposed to hear back from Rocco by noon. A spokesperson will be identified. Media attraction must be given to ensure we cover all the media sources.
- Miranda:** I concur. I've already contacted TV channels, radios and a few online bloggers. Our spokesperson should be prepared to answer media questions and participate in interviews.
- Janet:** Absolutely. Also, nothing generates more media coverage than a lack of honesty. Consequently, transparency in our statements must be projected through all communication channels.
- Miranda:** Are we supposed to inform Holly's employees?
- Janet:** Yes. This could be done with a simple e-mail. It should be emphasized that business continues as smoothly as possible.
- Miranda:** Farmani mentioned not saying a word to customers and stakeholders.
- Janet:** We are a personal relations firm, Miranda. We're supposed to communicate with people. We don't want them to learn about the crisis through the media. Notice must be given to them. Customers and stakeholders will be updated regularly as part of our crisis communication plan.
- Miranda:** Right. Summary statements, updated action plans and new developments will be sent as early and as often as possible. Peter's supposed to help me with that.
- Janet:** Great. This plan might be given priority. We live in a time of 24/7 news cycles. This should be reflected in our crisis plan.



Let's Practice!

How to get out of a sticky* situation.

*A "sticky" situation is one that is tricky or difficult.

Instructions: Underline the incorrect words. Write in the correct words. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. My professor had always told me that "one can never be prepared for a crisis".
2. Our spokesperson should be prepared to answer media questions and participate in interviews.
3. Consequently, transparency in our statements must be projected through all communication channels.
4. It should be emphasized that business continues as smoothly as possible.
5. Customers and stakeholders will be updated regularly as part of our crisis communication plan.



Let's Practice!

What was supposed to happen at the office?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing words. Choose from: wasn't supposed, I'm supposed to, Are we supposed to, We are supposed to, supposed to. Read the completed sentences aloud.

1. We all know this _____ happen, Janet.
2. _____ hear back from Rocco by noon.
3. _____ inform Holly's employees?
4. _____ communicate with people.
5. Peter's _____ with that.





Extension Activity

Make a list of all the things you are supposed to do this week.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Using point form, make a list of all the things that you need to do this week.
- Convert each item on this list into a complete sentence using "I am supposed to ..."
- Share your list with a partner.
- Provide your partner with feedback on how they might complete their tasks.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I make a "to-do" list.

☐ ☐

I write about things I am supposed to do.

☐ ☐

I share my plans with a partner.

☐ ☐

I provide my partner with feedback.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **spokesperson** (noun): someone who speaks to the public on behalf of an organization
e.g. A spokesperson will make the statement.
- **to ensure** (verb): to make certain that something happens
e.g. Media attraction must be given to ensure we cover all the media sources.
- **to concur** (verb): to agree
e.g. I concur with your assessment.
- **a lack of** (expression): not enough of something
e.g. Also, nothing generates more media coverage than a lack of honesty.
- **transparency** (noun): a business activity which is done openly and without secrets
e.g. Consequently, transparency in our statements must be projected through all communication channels.
- **to project** (verb): to calculate an amount expected in the future
e.g. Consequently, transparency in our statements must be projected through all communication channels.
- **to (not) say a word** (expression): to keep a secret; to not speak about something
e.g. Farmani mentioned not saying a word to customers and stakeholders.





Learning Points

Passive of Modal Verbs

The passive voice is commonly used in English. We use the passive when the 'doer' (agent) of the action is not so important. We are not interested in knowing who did the action. Our attention is on the object. Here's some more information about the passive of modal verbs.

a. Future form: subject + will + be + past participle

- *This issue will be dealt with.*
- *A new spokesperson will be identified.*
- *Updated plans and new developments on the story will be sent as early and as often as possible.*

b. Modals: can / could + be + past participle

We use these forms to talk about present and past possibility.

- *No one can be prepared for a crisis like this.*
- *This could be done with a simple e-mail.*

c. Modals: must / should + be + past participle

These forms are used to talk about necessity and advisability.

- *The spokesperson should be prepared to deal with the media and partake in interviews.*
- *It should be emphasized that we will continue to operate as usual.*
- *Current updates should be reflected in our plan.*
- *Media updates must be given to ensure we cover our bases.*
- *Transparency must be projected in our speech.*





Learning Points

Be Supposed To

In the business world, expectations are common since there are rules, agreements or people who are in charge. When we talk about those expectations, we use the expression "be supposed to". Here's more on how you can use it.

- Form: be + (not) + supposed to + bare infinitive (verb without to)
- Meaning: "Be supposed to" shows expectations. Someone expects you to do something in the present or in the future. It can also describe a past expectation.

Examples:

- *We know this wasn't supposed to happen. (It happened but we didn't expect it to happen)*
- *Are we supposed to inform the company's employees?*
- *We're supposed to communicate with people.*
- *I am supposed to hear back from them by next week.*
- *Am I supposed to be at the meeting on Tuesday?*
- *He's supposed to help me with that.*

